

▼ General

[Collapse all](#)

[Land Acknowledgement](#)

[Native Land Digital](#)

"The University of Alberta respectfully acknowledges that we are situated on Treaty 6 territory, traditional lands of First Nations and Métis people."

Visit [Native Land Digital](#), a beautiful and informative site that can help you understand more about traditional territories here in Alberta and around the world.

Statement on ChatGPT, Bing, and other Generative AIs

- Expectations in this course: use them for creative learning, study, preparation, but ChatGPT does not constitute a valid source for citation and quotation
- Factual inaccuracy, cultural bias, unreviewed source, no data beyond 2021
- the [Code of Student Behaviour](#) states: "No Student shall represent another's substantial editorial or compositional assistance on an assignment as the Student's own work." Submitting work created by generative AI and not indicating such would constitute cheating as defined above.
- The value and purpose of developing your own voice is essential to establishing creative, critical, analytic, research, and communication skills: for example, in our class we practice "writing to learn" because that's how you develop those skills and retain knowledge: if you're getting a machine to do it for you, save your money and quit university because you're not learning.
- Provost's Taskforce on Artificial Intelligence and the Learning Environment: more to come!

[Accommodations](#)

Hidden from students

[Glossary of Poetic Terms](#)

This resource is located at poets.org and is a good reference library for key poetic terms with illustrative examples.



[CLC Poetry Contest!!!](#)

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The Canadian Literature Centre is staging a poetry contest open to students at UAlberta!

\$500 Prize!

Deadline is March 13, 2023.

[Contribute a poem about happiness!](#)

March 20 is the International Day of Happiness! The Days of Action committee for International Day of Happiness, in partnership with the U of A Library, invites YOU to contribute a poem that explores your experience of happiness and what it means to you. Check out the details at this link.

▼ Week 1: Introductions & Syllabus Review (Jan 05)

Course Description: This course will provide an introduction to a diverse range of poets and poetries with a focus on poetic forms, modes of production and circulation, and contexts of reception in order to think about ways poetry produces meaning and value. We'll read some conventional and canonical poetry alongside innovative and experimental works, examples of poetry in popular culture and various media, and we'll do so with an attention to the work of creative individuals across diverse cultures, histories, and geographies. We'll develop some terminology for talking about poetry, and we'll explore strategies for thinking about poetic meaning and where, and how, it might be located.

Instructor: Mike O'Driscoll

Office: HC 3-29

E-mail: mo@ualberta.ca

Office Hours: Zoom: Wednesdays 1:00-2:00 <https://us02web.zoom.us/j/6354152761>

In Person: Fridays 11:00-12:00 HC 3-29

Course Location, Days & Time: Tuesday & Thursday 2:00-3:20, TB 108



[Syllabus](#)

Please read this syllabus carefully, as it details key dates, assignments, grading schema, late policies, and other important information. The syllabus also includes sections on Student Responsibilities, which you are required to be familiar with, and some helpful information on ensuring a positive learning environment.

[John Keats, "Ode to a Nightingale"](#)

We'll read this together in class as one way to get us thinking about poetry!



[Tzara's Hat Poem](#)

Here's the poem we produced together in our first class using the Tzara's Hat method. Nicely done!

▼ Week 2: What, when, why is a poem? (Jan 10-12)

We'll begin our conversations by talking about how we recognize poetry, and what we expect it might be doing. Here are a few poems that, as poetry so often does, reflect on their own form and function.

Shakespeare, "[Sonnet 55](#)"; Bradstreet, "[The Author to Her Book](#)"; Moore "[Poetry](#)"; Wallace Stevens "[Of Modern Poetry](#)"; MacLeish "[Ars Poetica](#)"; Williams "[The Red Wheelbarrow](#)"; Bernstein "[Being a Statement on Poetics](#)"; Maracle "[Language](#)"



[Lecture 02 Powerpoint](#)



[Lecture 03 Powerpoint](#)

▼ Week 3: Figurative Language Part One (Jan 17-19)

We'll spend a couple of weeks talking about figurative language in poetry, focusing on rhetorical tropes such as metaphor, conceit, simile, metonymy, synecdoche, apostrophe, and personification. We'll also spend some time developing our close reading skills and refining strategies for engaging poetry at the level of literal and figurative meaning.

Shelley "[Ozymandias](#)"; Yeats "[The Second Coming](#)"; Rich "[Diving into the Wreck](#)"; Frost "[The Road not Taken](#)"; Hughes "[Harlem](#)"; Atwood "[\[you fit into me\]](#)"; Yeats "[The Circus Animal's Desertion](#)"; Poe "[To Helen](#)";



[Engl 206 Lec 04 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Lec 05 Powerpoint](#)



[Adrienne Rich "When We Dead Awaken"](#)

In case you're interested in reading Rich's essay that we discussed in class, I've included it here.

▼ Week 4: Figurative Language Part Two (Jan 24-26)

More figurative language!

Dumont, ["the land she came from"](#) and ["Helen Betty Osborne"](#); Thomas ["The Hand That Signed the Paper"](#); Stevens ["Thirteen Ways of Looking at a Blackbird"](#); Birney ["Vancouver Lights"](#); Donne ["The Flea"](#); Keats ["Ode on a Grecian Urn"](#); Williams ["This is Just to Say"](#); Pound ["In a Station of the Metro"](#); H.D. ["Oread"](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 06 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 07 Powerpoint](#)



[Dwayne Donald "Edmonton Pentimento: Re-Reading History in the Case of the Papaschase Cree"](#)

We discussed this article by Dwayne Donald in class. This is not required reading, but in case you're interested I'm posting it here. This is a very important work that both provides background to Marilyn Dumont's poem "the land she came from," but also tells an important story that we should all hear.

✓ Week 5: The Sound of Poetry Part One (Jan 31-Feb 02)

What's special about the way poetry sounds, and how do we talk about those sounds?

Hopkins ["Pied Beauty"](#); Williams ["The Dance"](#); Dickinson ["A Bird came down the Walk"](#); Plath ["Daddy"](#); // Belcourt ["NDN Homopoetics"](#) and ["Ode to Northern Alberta"](#); Halfe ["Poems from The Crooked Good"](#); Tagaq ["Colonizer"](#) and ["Tongues"](#) (videos);



[Engl 206 Lecture 08 Powerpoint](#)



[Hopkins "Pied Beauty" Markup](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 09 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 6: The Sound of Poetry Part Two (Feb 07-09)

Let's keep listening to poems, and talk about ballads and lyrics.

Keats "[La Belle Dame sans Merci: A Ballad](#)"; Hughes "[The Weary Blues](#)"; Harper "[Dear John, Dear Coltrane](#)"; Baraka "[Three Modes of History and Culture](#)" and [print version of "Three Modes"](#); Smith "[Hip-Hop Ghazal](#)"; Amanda Gorman "[The Hill We Climb](#)" ([Video and Text](#)).



[Engl 206 Lec 10 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Lec 11 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Midterm Exam Outline](#)

[Just for fun: The American Inaugural Poets on poets.org](#)

✓ Week 7: Case Study: Sonnets, Then and Now (Feb 14-16)

Shakespeare "[Sonnet 18](#)"; EB Browning "[Sonnet XLIII](#)"; Millay, "[I, being born a woman and distressed](#)"; Lazarus "[The New Colossus](#)"; Clarke "[Blank Sonnet](#)"; Avison "[Butterfly Bones, or Sonnet Against Sonnets](#)" (for Tuesday only).

MID-TERM EXAM ON THURSDAY FEBRUARY 16!

For this assignment, you'll sit a Midterm Examination on Thursday, February 16 during regular class time. You'll be asked to read and analyze a short poem using some of the reading strategies and terminology we've modelled and developed so far. The answer will consist of a 500-750 word hand-written essay requiring careful close reading and analysis of a single poem, without the use of secondary sources. You'll have several poems from which to choose, none of which we will have previously considered.



[Engl 206 Lec 12 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 8: READING WEEK - NO CLASSES! (Feb 21-23)

✓ Week 9: Case Study: Eliot's The Waste Land (Feb 28-Mar 02)

Read [T.S. Eliot's The Waste Land](#) for this week! We'll likely focus on the first two sections, "The Burial of the Dead" and "A Game of Chess," on Tuesday. So try to have those read, at least, by then.

Perhaps one of the most celebrated poems in literary history, this is a very challenging read. If you go to the bottom of the poem, you'll find this version includes some helpful footnotes and, in bold type, occasionally Eliot's own footnotes to the poem.

But try not to get bogged down in the details with this one: instead, follow the play of metaphor, imagery, tone, and voice.

LAST DAY TO SUBMIT POETRY READING REPORT IS THURSDAY MARCH 2!

If you've been unable to attend a poetry reading in time for Thursday's deadline, you might consider listening to, and reporting on, one of the podcasts listed below. These are brought to you by the Canadian Literature Centre here on campus, and the options I've provided below were produced during COVID isolation as a way to keep CLC programming going during that period.

[Louise Bernice Halfe](#)

[J.R. Carpenter](#)

[Shannon Webb-Campbell](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 13 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 14 Powerpoint](#)

[Poetry Reading Report](#)

✓ Week 10: Literary Audio Part One (Mar 07-09)

Tennyson "[Charge of the Light Brigade](#)" and [print text](#); Yeats "[Lake Isle of Innisfree](#)" and [print text](#); Stein "[If I Told Him, A Completed Portrait of Picasso](#)" (print text on same link); Stevens "[The Idea of Order at Key West](#)" and [print text](#).



[Engl 206 Lecture 15 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 16 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 11: Literary Audio Part Two (Mar 14-16)

For Tuesday: Langston Hughes "[The Negro Speaks of Rivers](#)" and [print text](#); Allen Ginsberg "[A Supermarket in California](#)" and [print text](#); Belcourt, "[Gay Incantations](#)"; Charles Bernstein "[1-100](#)" and "[Phone Poem](#)";

For Thursday: Louise Bennett, "[Colonization in Reverse](#)" and [print text](#); Lillian Allen "[Revolutionary Tea Party](#)"; d'bi.young anitafrika "[River](#)"; Clifton Joseph "[Slo Mo](#)".

CLOSE LISTENING EXERCISE DUE ON THURSDAY MARCH 16!

[Close Listening Exercise - Read Me for more details and resources!!](#)



[How to Cite Audio in MLA Format](#)



[Engl 206 Lecture 17 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl206 Lecture 18 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 12: Sound Poetry and Spoken Word (Mar 21-23)

For Tuesday: Amiri Baraka ["Wailers"](#); Doug Barbour ["That Gone Tune"](#); Smith ["Two Kinds"](#); [Four Horsemen](#);

For Thursday: Nisha Patel ["Longing for You"](#); "Shima Robinson ["Instrumental"](#) (go down the page to find it); Titilope Sonuga ["The Women Are Talking"](#).



[Engl206 Lecture 19 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl206 Lecture 20 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 13: Spoken Word Continued (Mar 28-30)

Because Tuesday's class was cancelled, I've revised this week's topic for Thursday to simply continue our focus on Spoken Word. We'll take a look at some Indigenous Spoken Word artists and look ahead to our reading of Matthew Weigel's *Whitemud Walking*.

The Halluci Nation ["Mother Mother"](#); Leanne Betasamosake Simpson, ["How to Steal a Canoe"](#) and [print version](#); ["Leaks"](#); Janet Rogers ["Confederation 150 Mixdown"](#); Zoey Roy ["Up and Coming"](#);

SPOT SURVEY NOW AVAILABLE!

Student Perspectives of Teaching (SPOT) are now open. SPOT survey was created to gather feedback on courses to help instructors, departments, and faculties shape instruction and future curriculum. Feedback is anonymous and takes less than ten minutes to complete. [Complete your SPOT now.](#)

RESEARCH PAPER IS DUE ON ~~Tuesday April 4th~~!! EXTENDED TO THURSDAY, APRIL 6TH!!



[Research Paper: READ ME FOR A FULL DESCRIPTION!](#)

Read the attachment for a full description of the REVISED research paper assignment.

Please be sure to submit your essay as a word.doc !!!

The essay is now due Thursday, April 6 by midnight.



[Engl206 Lecture 21 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 14: Case Study: A Poetics of Place (April 04-06)

For our last full week of classes, we'll be reading and talking about Matthew James Weigel's 2022 volume of poetry *Whitemud Walking*. Weigel is a Dene/Métis poet and artist based here in Edmonton. His book is available for purchase at the University Bookstore in either print or digital versions. I'd **strongly** recommend the print version--it's a beautiful book! You can also purchase *Whitemud Walking* at a local independent bookstore, such as [Audrey's Books](#) downtown, or [Glass Bookshop](#) on 76th Avenue. This will be a chance for us to bring together many of the discussions we've had during the term and focus on a brilliant piece of work. Please purchase and read the book in advance of Tuesday's class. Matthew will be joining us for a reading and discussion!

REMINDER:

In advance of class, write out one question you would like to ask Matthew about his book.



[Engl206 Lecture 22 Powerpoint](#)



[Engl206 Lecture 23 Powerpoint](#)

✓ Week 15: Exam Review and Preps (April 11)



FINAL EXAM PREPARATION

The attached document is a template for the final exam, and details the three types of answers you'll be asked to complete.

Please review this document as you consider your preparation for the final exam.

✓ FINAL EXAM!

The final exam is scheduled for Monday, April 17 @ 9:00am-11:00am. TB 108.